

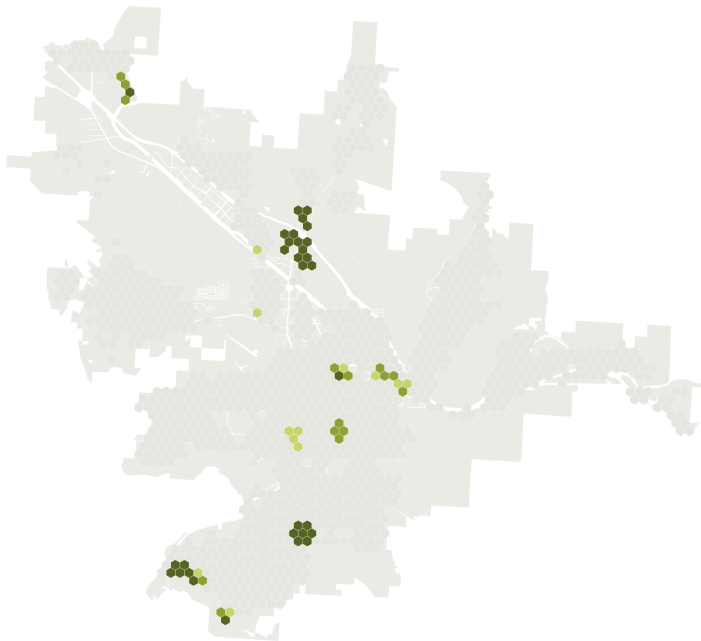
Missoula's next 43,000 homes are already on the books

The adopted Growth Policy makes room to nearly double the city's housing stock on vacant and underbuilt land — half of it small-scale infill, a third of it clustered in just 4% of the city.

Missoula's untapped housing capacity clusters in a few corridors

Each hex is scored by how much plan-enabled capacity it and its neighbors hold. Green hexes hold significantly more than random arrangement would produce (Getis-Ord Gi*); darker green = stronger statistical evidence.

Moderate cluster (90% confidence) Strong cluster (95% confidence)
Very strong cluster (99% confidence) No significant clustering



Source: City of Missoula taxlot data (2024). Analysis: capacity gap between Growth Policy future land use and existing dwelling units on unconstrained, economically soft parcels.

≈43,000

plan-enabled homes on 3,587 vacant and underbuilt parcels — no plan change needed

52%

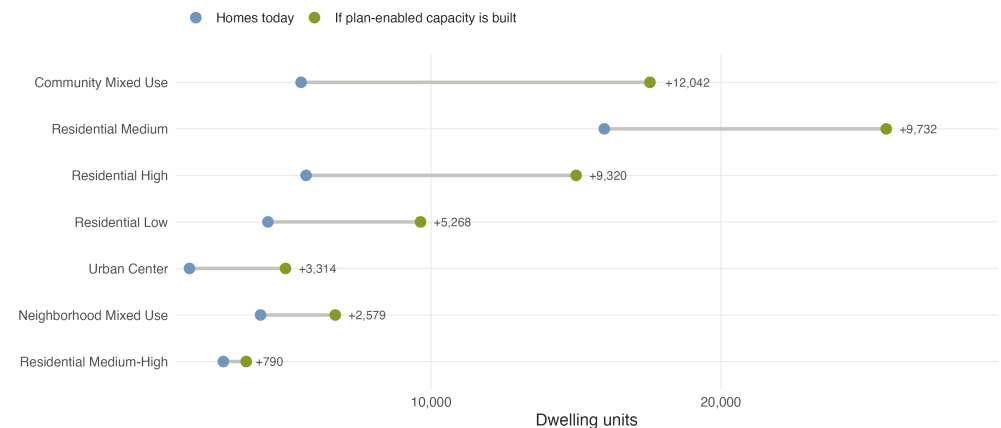
of capacity is infill on parcels ≤ 5 acres — unlocked by code, not land assembly

1/3

of capacity sits in 46 hot spots — just ≈4% of the urban fabric

The Growth Policy already makes room for ~43,000 more homes

Dwelling units by Growth Policy future land-use designation (not current zoning): today vs. with capacity on vacant and underbuilt parcels



Plan-enabled capacity = assumed allowable density x developable acres on unconstrained soft parcels, net of existing units. Density assumptions pending verification against the adopted Growth Policy.

What this means for the code reform

1. Align zoning with the plan in the hot-spot corridors (Mullan/Sxwtpqyen, midtown, south hills) — that's where entitlement friction costs the most homes.
2. Make small infill by-right: half the capacity sits on parcels a small builder can develop under simple rules.
3. Pair upzoning with mobile-home park preservation before surrounding land values move.

The counterpoint: 530 mobile-home parcels (≈2,850 of Missoula's most affordable homes) sit on land planned for higher density. They are excluded from the opportunity count — and are where preservation policy must move first.